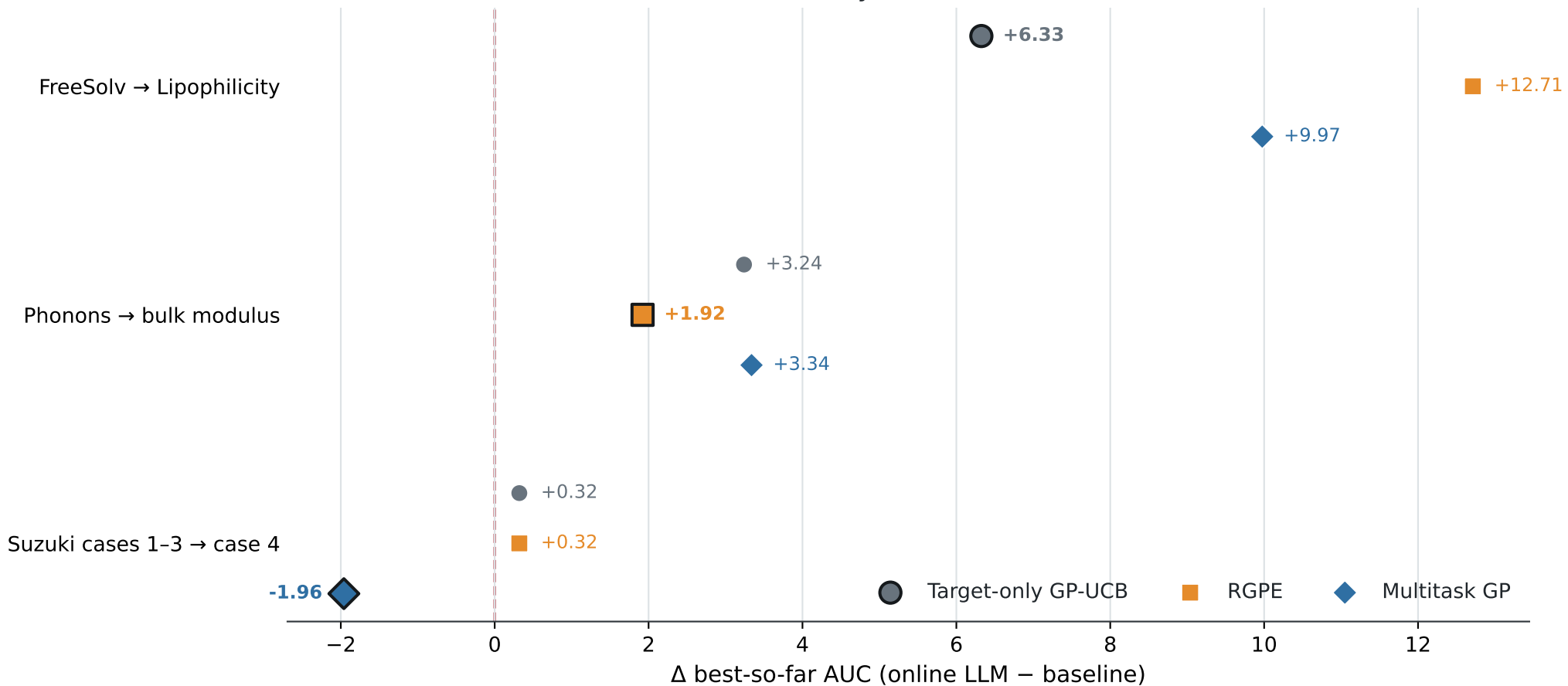


Same-start stress test: the LLM beats every baseline on 2 of 3 routes



Exact same initial candidates, pool and 10-reveal budget. Black outline marks the strongest realized baseline per route. Post-hoc, n=1 trajectory per route; no confidence interval.